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BY ELECTRONIC SUBMISSION

Thomas Keane, MD, MBA
Assistant Secretary for Technology Policy
Office of the National Coordinator for Health Information Technology
Department of Health and Human Services
Mary E. Switzer Building
330 C Street SW, Washington, DC 20201

Re: Attention: Request for Information: Request for Information: Accelerating the Adoption and Use of Artificial Intelligence as Part of Clinical Care

Dear Secretary Keane:

Thank you for the opportunity to submit comments in response to ONC's Request for Information regarding the adoption and use of artificial intelligence (AI) in clinical care. We commend ONC for its continued leadership in advancing innovation that improves healthcare quality, access, and efficiency.

The current trajectory of AI adoption in healthcare closely parallels that of telehealth prior to the COVID public health emergency. While the underlying technologies were mature and demonstrated measurable value, widespread implementation lagged due to regulatory, reimbursement, and cultural barriers. The pandemic catalyzed regulatory flexibility, payment alignment, and broader clinical acceptance, accelerating telehealth integration into routine care delivery.

AI-enabled tools appear to be at a similar inflection point. Health systems are increasingly recognizing AI's capacity to enhance access, improve operational efficiency, and support clinical decision-making at scale.

Significant gaps in access, workforce capacity, and chronic disease management persist across the United States. Addressing these challenges does not require waiting for a crisis-driven catalyst; rather, it calls for proactive policy alignment that fosters responsible innovation.

For example, we feel that Helfie AI's platform can enhance current remote patient monitoring programs, be utilized for pre-admission triage and post-discharge support, and can augment the management of chronic disease in a safe and effective way. Using a standard smartphone and advanced AI algorithms, Helfie uses remote photoplethysmography to estimate and trend a patient's vital signs: blood pressure, heart rate, oxygen saturation, respiratory rate, HRV, and physiologic stress. It also performs cough analysis to identify chronic respiratory issues like COPD, asthma, and others. Helfie's suite of AIpowered checks are highly accurate, take seconds to perform, and do not require the purchase of additional devices. Combined with powerful medical insights, Helfie makes early disease detection and prevention simple, accessible, and delightful. All from a patient's own hands, at population scale -no matter where they are, or who they are. Our comprehensive platform delivers a personalized health AI for patients through the aggregation of unique data streams and robust interoperability.

To facilitate broader patient access to technologies of this nature, continued efforts to streamline regulatory pathways within the FDA Software as a Medical Device (SaMD) framework are important. HHS initiatives such as the TEMPO program demonstrate meaningful progress towards improved approval processes. Establishing clearer pathways for technologies engaged with FDA review to transition efficiently into parallel adoption mechanisms, including ACCESS-related initiatives, would further promote timely and responsible deployment.

At the same time, regulatory modernization must be accompanied by strong safeguards for patients. AI-enabled clinical tools should adhere to rigorous standards of privacy, security, transparency, and data governance. Patients must remain empowered participants in their care, supported by technologies that meet the highest thresholds for trust, accountability, and clinical integrity.

Our objective is to reduce preventable morbidity and mortality by enabling earlier identification and proactive management of health conditions before they progress to complex and costly acute episodes. With thoughtful regulatory alignment and sustained collaboration, AI-enabled tools can advance patient-centered care at population scale.

We appreciate ONC's engagement on this important issue and stand ready to contribute further as policies evolve to support safe, effective, and equitable integration of AI into clinical practice.

Sincerely,

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